EXAMS COUNCIL OF ESWATINI

ECESWA

Examination Report

Agriculture

6882

EGCSE

2025

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Paper 6882/01
Theory

EGCSE Agriculture Paper 2 consists of two (2) sections, SECTION A (70 Marks): - Structured Questions and SECTION B (30 marks): - Essay questions. This paper contributes 40% of the overall mark.

Section A: General Comments on Agriculture Paper 2 The 2025 cohort performed fairly lower than the 2024 cohort, with the highest mark in 2025 being 74% and 75% for 2024. More candidates scored higher marks in 2024 Agriculture paper 2 examination compared to 2025. The lowest score in 2025 was 00/100 and the highest was 74/100. On the overall, the paper proved to be challenging to most of the candidates. There were 7123 candidates who sat for the 2025 EGCSE Agriculture examination compared to 6611 candidates for 2024. The paper was appropriate and relevant to the grade level of the candidates. It also covered all sections of the syllabus from general agriculture to agricultural engineering. Structural changes on the paper were as follows: Section A was marked out 70 marks and Section B marked out of 30 marks just like the exam in 2024.

Inappropriately defined agricultural terms and use of technically wrong words were noted as a key setback for candidates. There is an observed improvement in adherence to command words when responding to questions though there is continued failure to describe processes or practical procedures in chronological order, resulting in loss of marks for disorderly mentioned points.

Parts of the syllabus that seemed to be challenging to candidates:
Question 1 (b) (ii) - Candidates were only able to state selective breeding but failed to explain how it is done.
Question 1 (c) – Candidates only linked responses to market research but failed to give purpose of agricultural research.
Question 3 (c) – Candidates only defined the process of fertilisation in plants but failed to describe the process.
Question 4 (c)- Candidates failed to give explanations on the use of the rake resulting in loss of marks.
Question 5(d) – Candidates gave general reasons for weaning instead of focused responses to early weaning.
Question 7 (e) – candidates stated disadvantages of communal grazing instead of focusing on poor breeding as a practice in communal grazing.
Question 9 (c), – Candidates failed to list the commercial farming technics and further failed to suggest how they were suitable for world trade.

Section A: Structured Questions

Answer **all** questions in this section (70 marks)

Question 1

Fig 1.1 shows a genetically modified (GM) leguminous crop.

Fig 1.1

(a) (i) Identify the crop shown in **Fig 1.1**.

Expected responses

- beans **R** – legumes

Comments

This question was well answered by most of the candidates. The response 'legumes' was not accepted.

(ii) Describe what is meant by genetically modified organisms (GMOs).

Expected responses

- an organism that has a gene/ DNA from another species; inserted/ transferred into the DNA of the organism; which produces changes not natural to the organism

OR

an organism whose genetic material has been altered by the insertion of a gene/ DNA from another organism/ using genetic engineering; in organisms that cannot be crossbred

Comments

Most candidates correctly identified that ‘genetic alteration’ is involved, others focused solely on the part of ‘traits being modified’. Candidates failed to score all three points due to failure to locate the three essential components of the definition. Most candidate’s referred to GMOs only for crops but not livestock.

(b) (i) Suggest **two** health related problems of consuming genetically modified (GM) crops.

Expected responses

- risk of an allergic reaction in some people; risk of higher levels of a toxin chemical in food/ liver damage; prone to development of cancer cells

Comments

Some candidates wrote answers in reference to general health problems not relating to GMOs. Candidates misunderstood the problems of GMOs with advantages of growing GMOs crops e.g. long shelf life and high yielding, which were not correct responses for this question.

(ii) Explain how high yielding crops can be achieved without using genetic modification.

Expected responses

- Selective breeding/ choose a crop with desired traits to breed for maximum yields/ trait; further selection from offspring, so that the prevalence of the desired trait(s) increases; continue over a number of generations until pure breeding/ stable.

Comments

Candidates could not relate their responses to selective breeding. Common responses were in reference to ‘farming practices ‘adding organic matter’, ‘use of GMOs’ and ‘cross breeding’. Candidates gave answers based on ways of improving crop yields instead of producing high yielding varieties as per the requirement of the question.

(iii) Describe the requirements for importing genetically modified seeds into Eswatini.

Expected responses

- seek a permit from the Eswatini Environmental Authority; verify seed certification

Comments

Common errors to the question included getting license and getting an import permit. Candidates answers needed to be referred to permit from the EEA or seed certification.

(c) The use of GM technology worldwide can be contentious.

Explain why policy makers need agricultural research.

Expected responses

- To be informed/ have facts/ use findings; to support decision making.

Comments

Most candidates outlined the importance of market research in general. Actually, most candidates' answers related to market research instead of the role of research on agriculture development. Some candidates' responses only highlighted that agricultural research help policy makers with information but failed to explain how policy makers will then benefit from the new information.

Question 2

Fig 2.1 shows a delivery truck containing farm produce.

Fig 2.1

(a) (i) State the marketing function achieved in **Fig 2.1**.

Expected response

- Transport

Comments

Most candidates responded correctly to this question. A few candidates mentioned the other marketing functions such as advertising and storage. Wrong responses included milk, parmalat, delivery truck, and exporting truck.

(ii) Suggest **two** precautions that need to be taken to avoid product spoilage.

Expected responses

- refrigerated/ cold; sterilized/ clean containers; sealed/ airtight.
  Speed of delivery/quick delivery.

Comments

The common errors included 'cool storage' instead of 'cold storage' and others wrote 'free circulation of air' instead of 'airtight' as well as 'clean environment' instead of 'clean containers'. Another common error was giving responses which were not in line with the advertised product in the picture.

(b) Describe **two** roles of National Maize Corporation (NMC) in agribusiness.

Expected responses

Advise farmers on maize/ beans production; provide input/ tractor hire subsidy;
Collect/ store harvested maize/ beans; process/sell maize/ beans; provide market for maize/ beans; standardize prices of maize/ beans.

Comments

Most candidates were able to correctly state the roles of the NMC. However, a few candidates gave responses like NMC provides loan to farmers and educate farmers on how to grow crops which were not accepted. Other candidates could not relate their responses to grains crops (maize/ bean). Most candidates were able to mention 'provides subsidy' but failed to qualify by stating 'input/ tractor subsidy'.

(c) Explain how the use of technology on the farm can improve production.

Expected responses

Work is done faster/ time efficient; technology can create high yielding seeds/ livestock; use of computers monitor growing conditions/ irrigation; reduces labour costs.

Comments

A number of responses from candidates focused on research rather than technology. Furthermore, many candidates provided responses such as fast and time efficient without linking how these improvements directly impact production.

Question 3

Fig 3.1 shows a maize plant.

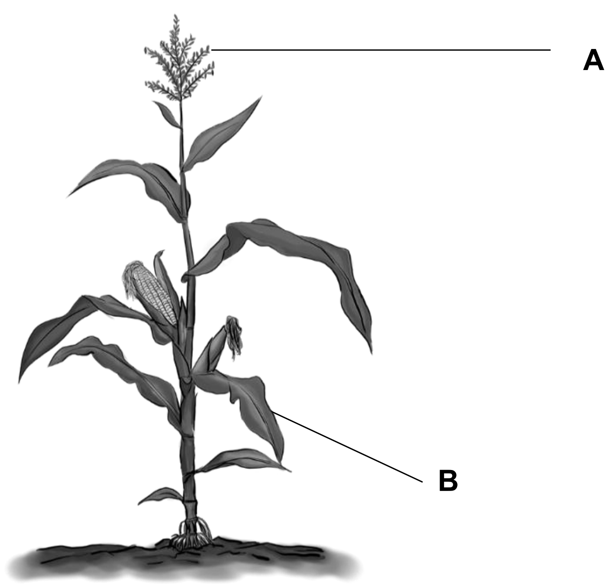

Fig 3.1

(a) (i) Name the part labeled **B** on **Fig 3.1**.

Expected responses

- **B -** silk/ feathery styles **R** – stigma

Comments

Most candidates wrote answers like 'cob', 'stigma' and 'hairs', flower, tassel and anther that were rejected responses in this question.

(ii) State the structure and function of **A** on **Fig 3.1**.

Expected responses

- **A**/ tassel contains anthers; which produce pollen grains.

Comments

Most candidates stated functions of a petal as simply attracting pollinating agents and functions of the anthers instead of stating that tassels contain anthers that produce pollen grains.

(b) Outline how the flowers of a maize plant are adapted for wind pollination.

Expected answers

- large amount of pollen; light pollen; exposed anthers; feathery styles

Comments

Some candidates gave responses in relation to mechanisms of wind pollination instead of adaptations
of flowers for wind pollination. Candidates were writing pollen grains are blown by wind from the anther to the stigma. Other candidates were outlining the process of pollination in general.

(c) Describe the process of fertilisation in a flowering plant.

Expected responses

- pollen absorbs moisture from receptive stigma; develops pollen tube that grows
through the style carrying male gametes to ovule; fusion of sex cells/ gametes resulting to zygote/ embryo / seed forms

Comments

Candidates wrote responses tat related to describing the process of pollination instead of fertilization. Some could not relate their responses to the relevant terms of the process such as male gametes fuse with the female gametes to form an embryo/ zygote.

(d) Give details of the climatic conditions required to grow maize.

Expected responses

temperature range of 18 to 30^{0}C; rainfall range of 600 -900mm

Comments

Most candidates gave general answers like ‘high rainfall’, ‘sunny site’, ‘rainy season’, enough rainfall, warm temperature yet the question required a temperature range and a range of favorable rainfall. Common errors include giving temperature and rainfall ranges outside the recommended ones such as 16 degrees celcius and rainfall of 500mm.

Question 4.

Fig 4.1 shows land being cleared for agricultural activities.

Fig 4.1

(a) (i) Name the land clearing activity shown in **Fig 4.1**.

Expected responses

- Cutting

Comments

Most candidates responded correctly to this question item. However, a few candidates wrote responses such as ‘deforestation’ and ‘clearing’ which were not accepted.

(ii) State **two** immediate activities needed to complete land clearing in **Fig 4.1**.

Expected responses

- stumping; burning

Comments

Some candidates’ responses included ‘deforestation’, ‘digging stems’, which were rejected.

(b) Suggest **two** reasons for cultivating the soil before planting.

Expected responses

- loosen the soil for ease of planting/ germination/ opening of planting stations/furrows; kill/ burry weeds; incorporate organic matter/ plant residues in the soil; expose pest/ diseases to harsh conditions

Comments
Some candidates gave correct points without qualifying them or giving explanation. This resulted in the loss of marks yet correct points were outlined.

(c) Explain **two** ways a rake can be used to create a seed bed.

Expected responses

prongs remove debris/ stones/ waste for fine tilth;
prongs provide shallow surface tillage for ease of germination;
prongs create a level surface to prevent erosion/ making planting stations;
prongs crush large lumps/ clods for suitable soil tith **(any two)**

Comments
Candidates stated correct points about the functions of a rake but couldn't explain how a rake could be used to create the seedbed, this partial answering of the question made them to lose marks. Responses such as level the soil and prepare a fine tilth without qualifying them were common.

(d) Describe **two** soil amendments needed for proper growth of crops.

Expected responses

- Lime-reduce soil acidity/increases pH slightly acidic to neutral/ gypsum-increase soil acidity/ reduces pH to slightly acidic to neutral; fertilizers-improve soil fertility; organic fertilisers-improve the soil structure

Comments

Most candidates could state the amendments correctly but could not state why they were used. Other candidates confused amendments for characteristics of the soil e.g. fertile soils, improved soil structure and well aerated soils which were not correct responses.

(e) Complete the table below on the maintenance of tools used in land preparation.
The maintenance entered must be different for each tool.

Expected responses

- fork –straighten tines; repaint/ oil; proper storage/ keep dry; tighten nuts/ bolts; remove soil/ clean/ wash
- spade – clean/ remove soil/ wash; repaint/oil; proper storage/ keep dry;

Comments

This question was well done by candidates. Common errors included repeating the same ways of maintaining both tools, yet the question stated that the maintenance entered must be different for each tool.

Question 5

Fig 5.1shows the reproductive system of a cow.

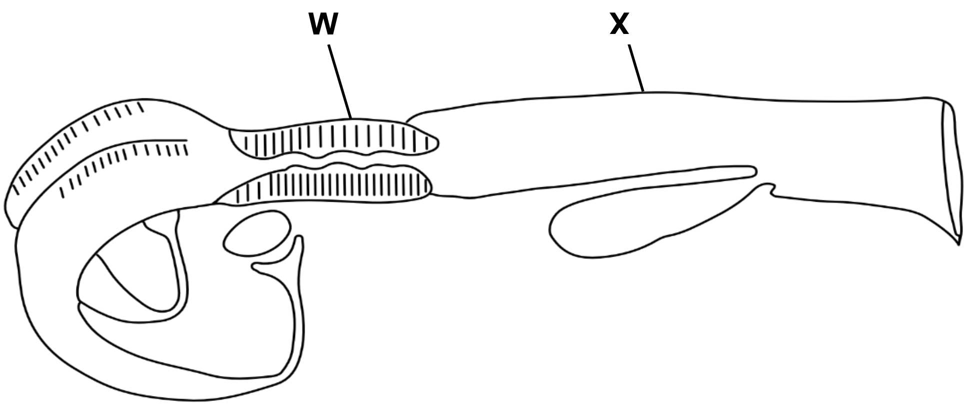

Fig 5.1

(a) (i) Name the part labelled **X** on **Fig 5.1**.

Expected responses

- vagina

Comments

A majority of the candidates got this question correctly. Those who got it wrong gave answers like 'penis', 'artificial insemination', fallopian tube, cervix, rectum, rumen, stomach and vulva. Some candidates were able to identify the part labeled X (vagina) but could not write the correct spelling such as virgnia and virgina.

(ii) Explain the importance of part **W** in a pregnant cow.

Expected responses

- seals the uterus; prevents entry of pathogens/ so prevents abortion

Comments

A few candidates provided a correct explanation, but other candidates were describing functions of the uterus. A common mistake was failing to identify that pathogens enter the body first to create an infection or disease. Full marks required mentioning the prevention of pathogen entry to the uterus.

(b) Explain the importance of the hormone relaxin when a pregnant cow is preparing to calve.

Expected responses

- relaxes the ligaments in the pelvis; to widen pelvic bones for birth
softens the muscles of the cervix/ birth canal; so that they dilate for birth

Comments

Most candidates wrote responses that related to functions of progesterone instead of relaxin. Candidates referred to contraction and relaxation of the uterus instead of that of the pelvic and cervix muscles. Common error included the enlargement of the vulvaas.

(c) State **two** reasons why colostrum is important to a young animal.

Expected responses

- Contains antibodies which prevents disease; appropriate nutrition/ balance diet to fight diseases; high level of nutrients (Ca, Protein, Vitamins) for relevant good growth; laxative for cleaning digestive system **(any two)**

Comments

Most candidates understood that colostrum is important, but many failed to state the specific reasons for providing it. Candidates wrote incomplete responses like ‘it contains antibodies’ instead of saying ‘it contains antibodies to fight diseases’, other responses were ‘availability of nutrients’ without qualifying it by adding that it ‘helps for proper growth’.

(d) Suggest **three** reasons for early weaning in cattle production.

Expected responses

- increase milk sales for higher returns; increase offtake by selling calves; early re-mating to increase productivity; reduce occurrence of disease/ infection

Comments

Most candidates failed to link the practice of weaning to the broader goal of cattle productivity. Candidates wrote responses in relation to weaning in general instead of early weaning. The common response was separating the calf from the mother to introduce it to solid foods.

Question 6

Table 6.1 shows the trends of consumption rate and mortality rate as stocking rate for broilers increases.

Table 6.1

Stocking rate (birds/ 10m^2)	Consumption rate over a six-week period (grams of feed/broiler)	Mortality rate (%)
50	3300	7.6
55	3275	7.8
60	3250	7.5
65	3225	7.5
70	3200	7.6
75	3175	7.6
80	3150	7.7
85	3125	7.7
90	3100	7.8
95	3075	7.9
100	3050	8.0

(a) (i) State the mass of feed eaten per broiler when the stocking rate is 75birds/10m^2.

Expected responses

- 3175g **(no units = 0)**

Comments

Most candidates lost marks resulting from failure to include the units of measurement.

(ii) Estimate the consumption rate of feed when the stocking rate is 110birds/10m^2.

Expected responses

- 3000g **(no units = 0)**

Comments

This question was generally well answered by most candidates; a few did not write units making it a rejected marking point.

(iii) Find the total mass of feed eaten by 100 birds in kilograms.

Expected responses

100 x 3050g = 305000g/ 1000g
= 305 kg

Comments

Most candidates got this answer wrong as they failed to divide by 1000 g and convert to kg; some candidates also failed to use the appropriate SI units.

(iv) Explain the relationship between the stocking rate and the consumption rate.

Expected responses

- inverse relationship/ as stocking rate increases, feed consumption decreases;
  due to competition/ less space/ less activity

Comments

Most candidates were able to explain the relationship between stocking rate and consumption rate though others simple defined stocking rate and consumption rate.

(v) Suggest **two** possible causes of high mortality rate when the stocking rate was 55 birds/10m^2.

Expected responses

- diseases outbreak; extreme weather conditions/ very cold/ excess heat; poor Management/ lack of water/ lack of feed/ no forking (**any two)**

Comments

Most candidates were able to suggest the causes of high mortality in birds. Some candidates did not understand the word mortality as they gave positive responses for the high mortality rate e.g. the management was good, and chickens were eating correct amount of feed.

(b) Explain the reason for feeding layers using restricted feeding method.

Expected responses

- avoids drop/ less/ low in production/ avoid loss of production; due to fat build up avoids drop in returns; due to feed wastage/ overfeeding

Comments

The question was poorly answered. Most candidates could not relate restrictive feeding to egg laying. Some wrote chickens will be overfed, obese and overweight, lazy to lay eggs which were incorrect responses.

Question 7

Fig 7.1 shows a dairy cow used for milk production.

Fig 7.1

(a) Name the identification method used in **Fig 7.1**.

Expected responses

- Ear tagging

Comments

This question was well answered by candidates. A few wrote ear lettering' and 'ear notching', 'earrings', 'ear number' which were wrong responses.

(b) State **two** signs of heat observed on the vulva of a cow.

Expected responses

- swollen/ enlarges/ thickens; wet vulva/ clear mucus discharge

Comments

Some candidates wrote mucus is observed around the vulva, not specifying the appearance, which is clear discharge. Some candidates mentioned responses like big, inflamed vulva instead of swollen and enlarged vulva. Some wrote white, yellow or red mucus instead of clear mucus discharge.

(c) Suggest **two** reasons for the dehorning in livestock.

Expected responses

- Easier handling: prevents damage to hides/ prevents injuries to other cows

Comment

Most candidates got this question correct. Common errors were that the animals gain weight, grow rapidly or faster, and become docile (less aggressive) instead of easy to handle. Some candidates wrote to avoid injuries from other cows instead of avoiding injuries to other cows.

(d) Explain why castration of young males affects their growth rate.

Expected responses

- Slows growth; due to low/ no testosterone production

Comments

Many candidates failed to get marks because they provided incomplete explanations, some simply repeated the question as their response, some wrote that 'castrated young bulls grew faster(big)' and some wrote slow growth' without linking it to low or no testosterone production.

(e) Explain how poor breeding practices on communal land may result in low cattle production.

Expected responses

- No selection/ haphazard mating; between weak/ old cattle mate viable/ young
Inbreeding: undesired traits inherited

Comments

Fairly answered question by most candidates, although some answers were commonly not related to poor breeding practices but related to communal land. Most responses given related to disease outbreak and poor pastures, which were incorrect. Candidates were giving general responses like cattle will have diseases and parasites.

Section B – Essay Questions

Answer any **two** questions in this section (30 Marks)

Question 8

(a) For **three** named soil types, explain how their properties affect crop production.

Expected responses

- **Loam soil;** crumb structure/ good aeration provides oxygen access for plants respiration/ fertile soil provides adequate nutrients for plant growth/ suitable pH promotes nutrient availability to plants/good root penetration for access of nutrients and water/ good water holding capacity to supply water for photosynthesis
- **Sandy soil;** poor structure with poor water retention/ high aeration resulting into good root respiration/ less fertile hence poor nutrients/ acidic soils which limit nutrients availability.
- **Clay soil;** tight structure results in poor aeration so poor oxygen access for root respiration/ poor root penetration hence low access to nutrients

Comments

The performance for this question was below average; only a few of candidates got it correct. A majority of candidates could state the soil type but failed to explain how it affects crop production.

(b) Describe **three** benefits of adding organic matter to the soil.

Expected responses

- improves structure as humus binds soil particles; release plant nutrients to increase soil fertility; humus improves water retention; humus prevents leaching of nutrients; improves microbial activity as organic matter is food to microorganisms.

Comments

Most candidates could not qualify their responses on how organic matter benefits the soil.

(c) Suggest, with reasons, how the **three** types of weathering contribute to soil formation.

Expected responses

Physical/mechanical; contributes size of soil particles stated activities
Chemical; contributes to available minerals through stated chemical reactions
Biological; living organisms contribute humus content from mention activities
A – use of examples

Comments

Most of the candidates failed to suggest how the types of weathering contribute to soil formation. A majority of the candidates only got 3/6 as they could not give an explanations or reasons.

Question 9

(a) For **three** named farming practices, explain how they contribute to food security.

Expected responses

- **Intercropping:** increase yields from combined harvest/ reduces total crop failure
- **crop rotation;** controls pests and diseases to improve crop quality and yield/ improves fertility though use of legumes/ soil structure maintained for good growth
- **mixed farming:** enterprises complement each other/ mutual benefit/ high yield from the combined harvest of crops and livestock/ optimise use of land for high yield
- **Monocropping;** technical know-how developed/ skills easily mastered/allows specialization for ease of management.

Comments

This question was answered well; however, some candidates failed to explain how it contributes to food security and a few indicated that farming practices were not known to them. Common responses were organic, permaculture, intensive farming, commercial and cash crop which were not awarded any marks.

(b) Suggest, with reasons, how **three** commercial farming practices are suitable for world trade.

Expected responses

- crops and animals provides food; source of income from sales; clothing from skins/ wool; organic fertilizers from crop residues/ animal waste; raw material for building/ fencing; job opportunities through self-employment, other people

Comments

This question was poorly answered; fewer candidates got it correct. The candidates failed to describe how the benefit comes about but could only *state* correct points.

(c) Describe **three** benefits of agriculture at family level.

Expected responses

- **large scale production**; cattle lots/ feedlots enable high output
- **use of technology**; computer controlled glasshouse/ greenhouses/ irrigation give high yield/artificial insemination yield/pesticides and fertilizers.
- **intensive farming**; large quantities of crops/ livestock produced in a small unit area
- **processing/value addition;** where raw products cannot be sold/ for higher returns
- **monoculture;** large quantities of the same product produced continuous supply

Comments

This question proved to be one of the most inaccessible questions as fewer candidates got this correct. Some candidates were either writing farming practices or systems i.e. repeating responses to question 9 (a). Most correct responses were on use of technology (use of machinery, improved seeds and fertilizer).

Question 10

(a) For **three** named livestock house features, explain how they prevent the spread of diseases.

Expected responses

Footbath; carries disinfectant/ prevent entry of pathogen;
Concrete floors; for easy cleaning and disinfecting;
Ventilators; for air circulation and drying/chicken wire fence to prevent wild birds/ snakes/ rats
Transparent sheets on roofing; for vitamin D/ light for proper feeding;
Concrete wall; for protection against bad weather/ ease of cleaning/ disinfection;
Corrugated iron roofing; for protection against rain/direct sunlight
Isolation pens; so that infected stock does not spread diseases

Comments

This question was poorly answered. Some candidates were writing responses that related to controlling diseases in the poultry house.

(b) Describe **three** signs of respiratory diseases in livestock.

Expected responses

- undesired noise - coughing; sneezing; difficulty in breathing; eye /nasal discharge/ running noise

Comments

This was a poorly answered question. Only about 30% of the candidates got it correct. Candidates wrote responses that were relating to general signs of ill health in livestock production, yet the question was specific to signs of respiratory diseases in livestock. Most candidates could only state difficulty in breathing as a correct response.

(c) Suggest, with reasons, how three methods of controlling parasites and diseases improve livestock production.

Expected responses

- vaccination; increase immunity; dipping/ spray race; controls ticks/ external parasites; deworming/drenching/injection; controls internal parasites; disinfection/ sanitation/ hygiene; kills pathogens on surfaces; proper feeding; prevents deficiency diseases; selection of resistant animals; prevents diseases

Comments

This question was fairly answered. Some candidates could only listed the control method only but failed to explain how they improve livestock production. Some candidates used wrong terminology: ‘dip tank’ instead of ‘dipping’.

Section C: Comments on the question paper

- A majority of candidates attempted all the questions as per the instructions.
- The allocated time of 2 hours was adequate for writing this paper. Candidates had no challenges of time management.
- There was no common misinterpretation of the rubric.
- The 2025 candidates performed poorly than the comparable cohort of 2024.

Advice to Agriculture Teachers

- The assessment covers all sections of the syllabus, from the first unit (General Agriculture) up to the last unit (Agriculture Engineering). All questions were fairly attempted by the candidates
- Emphasis should be made on description of experimental procedures and processes in chronological order.
- Candidates should be taught and tested on all levels i.e. in reference to the command words used in the syllabus.
- Further emphasis should be made on the appropriate usage of technical terms used in agriculture when explaining concepts. In most cases, where technical terms are not used appropriately, candidates' responses become unacceptable.
- The performance of candidates in most sections has improved compared to previous years. Further focus is necessary to ensure all sections of the assessment syllabus are sufficiently taught.
- A further need to relate practical work to theoretical facts remains key for understanding of some concepts.
- Teachers should make use of Examination Reports from the previous years as they teach their candidates.

Paper 6882/03
Practical Activities

Practical Activities

This paper tests the practical skills, which is objective C of the syllabus. The practicals were developed by the Examination Council of Eswatini (ECESWA). Each practical had two sections: practical assessment sheet and processed skills. The practical activities were assessed by the teachers in the centres using the descriptors provided by ECESWA. The processed skills were written as an exam paper in centres and were marked by the teachers at the centres. All centres were able to submit their course work to ECESWA on time.

Registers

All centres submitted their registers. This year filling of registers was a challenge for some centres. The following were observed: there were centres who had no page totals, dates, invigilator's name and signature. In some centres the registers showed only the sampled candidates in the column for script submitted.

Expected: Centres are expected to indicate with three (3) ticks for candidates who have written all three processed skills and indicate with (x) on their candidates who did not write the processed skills. All candidates who have submitted their practical work must be indicated in the registers. Teachers are reminded to complete the registers, sign them, indicate date of completion, as well as the name of the teacher responsible.

Sitting plan

Most centres submitted the sitting plan for all three processed skills. Centre are encouraged to enclose the sitting plan in the ECESWA envelop with the candidates files.

Teacher's File

The teacher's file continues to be a challenge for some centres. There were centres who included candidates' pictures in this file.

Expected: All Centres are expected to submit the teacher's file. It should include the following:
Diaries for the centre to show what was supposed to be done or was required by the practical. It should give a guide on what is expected to be seen in the candidates' diaries and should have correct dates. This will assist in the moderation process.

The teacher's file is important as it guides moderation with the correct dates for activities in each centre, it also highlights challenges faced in centres and assists in explaining deviation from the marking guide given by ECESWA.

Ampling

Even this year some centre had incorrect samples. Teachers are expected to sample a wide range of scores: top students, average students and low students. They are to indicate with asterisks (*) the sampled candidates on the Summary Sheet. Packaging of the student files should be according to the scores of the candidates, with the top candidates at the top and low students at the bottom. The sample should include the whole mark range obtained at the centre.

Centre are expected to sample using the sampling procedure indicated in the syllabus:
- Below 10: all candidates
- 11 – 50: 10 candidates
- 51- 100: 15 candidates
- Above 100: 20 candidates

Practicals that are not sampled should be submitted in a separate envelope from the sampled work and the envelope should also indicate that these are not sampled work.

Student Card

There was a great improvement on student cards, they were correctly placed in individual student's file. However, there were very few centres which omitted the process skills mark. In some centres marks were incorrectly transferred from marking criteria into the student card and very few centres had decimals on the student cards.

Expected: The student cards must be placed inside the student file and must be on top of the work. Whole numbers should be used when filling in the individual student card. Marks obtained by the student on the processed skills must be included on this card. Teachers are also encouraged to cross check student card's mark, with mark awarded on the marking criteria or processed skill mark.

Teachers are encouraged to ensure all candidates write all three process skills and do all three practical's as they are all needed in the computing of the final mark of the candidate**.** Teachers are reminded to include the marks for processed skills in the first column of the student card.

Summary sheet

There was an improvement on the summary sheets. However, the following challenges were still noted on some Summary Sheets:
- Some centres had totals which were not correlating with the marks awarded (incorrect adding)
- Few centres had no centre details, that is centre name or number
- Candidates with no marks or indication of being absent
- No teacher's details (name or contact number)
- No principal stamp or signature
- Loose sheets
- In some centres it was difficult to read numbers, as some teachers would write on top of another number or the numbers not clearly written
- Processed skill marks not included
- Some centres did not have asterisk (*) for the sampled candidates
- Some centres had decimals

Expected: Centres are to indicate in the Summary Sheet if a student is absent or missing and this should be in line with the register. They should thoroughly check if the marks are completed, and the totals are correct. No decimal should appear on the Summary Sheet. All Summary Sheets should have the teacher's details, principal signature and school stamp.

Practical Tasks

The practicals received this year were as follows:

- Topdressing cabbages
- Marketing eggs
- Phosphorus test

Teacher's comments

This year, teacher's comments seemed to be a great challenge in most centres. The following challenges were noted:

- Centres without teacher's comments.
- Some comments were general, not specific to the tasks.
- In some centres, teachers just wrote the same comments for all the students.
- In some centres comments were scanty.
- Few centres, had teachers ticking the descriptors then provided a negative comment.
- Very few centres had detailed comments justifying mark awarded to candidates.
- In some centres, the comments were of lower quality, Comments that were provided included the following: good, fair or excellent.
- In some centres the comments were just based on one descriptor.
- Some of the handwritings were difficult to read.

Expected: Teachers should make specific and detailed comments, and they must be relevant for the practical. Teachers are encouraged to make comments as they serve as a justification for the mark awarded.

Evidence

Even this year there was a decline on the evidence given by centres. The quality of the evidence given was low. This year some of the pictures and diaries submitted were irrelevant for the given practical's. Some centre submitted diaries that are scanty, and some were not marked. Most diaries lacked critical information and observations were not clearly stated. In some centres the pictures provided did not show the candidate performing the specific task e.g. topdressing cabbages, however, the picture will show a candidate harvesting cabbages.

Expected: pictures provided should show the candidate doing the specific task. Diaries should include major activities for the task.

Processed skills

Expected: All candidates are expected to sit for all three processed skills examination for that year, as processed skills are a component for paper 3.

1. Calculations

Some centres had challenges with calculations. The working was not shown but only the answers, whilst in other centres wrong units were used. Centres are encouraged to state the formula (if need be), show working and use relevant units. In most centres candidates were unable to calculate the expected number of cabbages in 4m by 4m plot, and the total number of fertiliser bags.

Expected: candidates are to show the working clearly and use the correct units.

2. Graphs

Drawing of line graphs continued to be a challenge for some centre. Some line graphs had incorrect scaling making it difficult to plot. Some of the axes were not well labelled, plotting was mostly incorrect and most graphs had no titles. For some centre the line graphs were not drawn at all.

Expected: candidates were to draw line graphs with title, label all axis and use correct scale in order to plot correctly.

3. Tables

The filling of tables was a challenge for most centre. For task 2, price given was not tallying to the cost in the table. In some centres there were blanks on the table, hence the table was incomplete. In some centres the number of eggs collected did not tally with the number of hens, total number of eggs were higher than the number of hens.

Expected: candidates were expected to complete the table without leaving blanks, zero eggs collected should indicated with a number (0) not a blank, the same should apply on the income made from egg sales.

4. Predictions

This section continues to be a challenge for most centres. In task 1 most candidates were unable to predict the effects of sufficient nitrogen. Candidates failed to make prediction of what could be the effect of overuse of phosphorus fertiliser in task 3.

Expected: candidates were expected to make predictions using known knowledge from theory in these tasks.

Marking of processed skills

In some centres marks were allocated without ticks, whilst others had ticks without marks being allocated. Some centres allocated marks more than the expected mark for the question. In some instances, teachers were awarding marks to incorrect answers, not following the given marking guide.

Expected: Centres were expected to allocate marks according to the facts given by the candidates. Teachers are expected to mark all the work written by candidates and award marks according to the facts given and using the mark scheme sent by ECESWA.

Cover letter

There was a higher number of absent candidates especially for the processed skills. Most of the centres submitted cover letters without head teacher's signature, stamp and contact details.

Expected: all absent candidates and Summary Sheets with zeroes should be accompanied by a covering letter with a valid reason. This letter should be checked and signed by the head of centre.

Packaging

Few Centres still fail to use simple folders and strings for their packaging. Some centres submitted loose materials in the individual candidate file. The individual files should have strings to prevent the candidate's work being misplaced or mixed-up during handling and moderation. Very few centres had no files at all. In some centre paper 3 and 4 were packed in the same candidate's file.

Expected: Centres are to submit their work in simple folders fastened secured with strings. Centre are discouraged to bind their work. Paper 3 and 4 are different papers they should be filed in different files and packaged into separate envelopes, with their own cover letters.

General comments

The number of absent students was higher this year. Teachers are encouraged to grade and submit the work done by the candidates. Teachers are encouraged to cross check marks in the summary sheet with the total mark given for each candidate. Individual file for candidate should have centre name and number and the candidate number.

Recommendations

Teachers who have just joined the profession are encouraged to consult ECESWA regarding the expected procedures for assessment. It is also recommended that teachers continue to share ideas within the department to minimize variation in the standard of work submitted by the centre. Teachers are still encouraged to respond promptly when clarity is required regarding their course work. Centres are encouraged to conduct practicals and fill-in descriptor marks on time to minimize mistakes and ensure accuracy.

Paper 6882/04
Project Work

General Comments

This paper tests students on practical skills, which is objective C in the syllabus. There was an almost similar performance in the quality of the work presented in this paper, with that of last year, 2024.

Appropriateness of the projects chosen

Almost, all the topics chosen were relevant and specific. This year, there was however a slight drop in the quality of topics chosen. Most centres still presented projects that were concentrated on vegetables and livestock and there was no spread/ distribution of topics across the syllabus. Teachers should ensure that topics are well spread over the syllabus content.

Teacher supervision

This year, there was a slight decline in teacher supervision, compared to the previous year, 2024. Teachers are encouraged to improve on candidates' supervision, throughout the project, and should stick to the guideline in the syllabus.

Topic, table of contents, bibliography

This section was averagely presented by most centres. Most topics were clear and relevant to the syllabus. Table of contents was well presented with clear page numbers by a few centres. Teachers are reminded to use roman figures when numbering table of contents, list of tables and list of charts. Other centres completely omitted list of tables, graphs and charts. A few topics did not show the dependent variable. Centres need to improve on reference citing. Centres are also encouraged to provide evidence in the form of diaries and pictures.

Presentation of Introduction

The introduction section was well presented by most centres as outlined in the guideline. However, the background required improvement by showing both variables under study. A few centres still need to improve on literature citation in the background information. Objectives need to also show both variables and be SMART. Centres are reminded to guide candidates as they write the null and alternative hypothesis. The importance of the study needs to focus on how the outcome will improve future production.

Limitations

Limitations are problems encountered during the study. This section continued to be a challenge. Limitations were listed without explaining how they affected the study and suggesting possible solutions to them. Some centres were writing this section in future tense while some omitted this section completely. Centres are encouraged to ensure that candidates identify, assess, and suggest improvements to the limitations of the project.

Literature Review

This component was well presented. Centres are encouraged to present literature that is at the level of the candidates and use proper citation standards. Centres are encouraged to use authentic authors and websites for citations in this section with at least 4.

Methodology

This year, there was a slight improvement in the presentation of the project plan. However, a few centres still presented a scanty plan. The plan should be detailed, showing research design, materials used and their uses, procedure followed (showing dates and how work was done from preparations up to harvesting/ slaughtering or marketing), layout, randomization, replication, population and sampling, data collection, data analysis and data presentation format. A few centres presented a procedure which was shallow and without dates when work was done, materials without uses. Few other centres presented a plan with the procedure but without data collection, data analysis and data presentation format. Others were confusing data analysis with data presentation format; while others were confusing data collection with data analysis format, in the plan. Centres are encouraged to follow the syllabus guideline. Data collection and analysis need to be presented per objective.

Results and deductions

Results:

This year, there was a slight improvement in this section, as most candidates presented data for all the objectives. Most centres presented data using tables which were interpreted, graphs and charts labelled, with proper scaling and drawn in graph papers.

Tables have to be labelled and interpreted, graphs and charts drawn on graph papers and not in lined papers. The key is always necessary. However, a few centres still presented a shallow data. Tables, charts and graphs were still not labelled and without brief interpretations. There was very little variation in data presentation i.e., tables, pie charts, histograms, bar charts, linear graphs (showing S.I. units) used for different objectives. Very few candidates did not have data at all. Some centres presented unrealistic data in this section.

Data for each objective should always be presented in a table first, before drawing the graphs or charts. Teachers should advise candidates to use different patterns to differentiate the variables in the charts or graphs. Teachers are also encouraged to ensure that candidates do the investigatory project and ensure that data is properly collected.

Discussion:

This year, there was an improvement in literature citation in this section. There was however a drop in scientific reasoning for the results. Most centres did not justify or express their results with reasons for the differences. This section is the core of the project. It should give a clear picture and understanding of the whole project. The deductions should cover each of the objectives (stated in chapter 1) under study.

Summary, Conclusion and Recommendations

Summary:

A few centres did not include findings of the study in the summary. Very few other centres completely omitted this section. Centres are encouraged to stick to the syllabus guideline.

Conclusion:

Most centres were able to relate their conclusion with the hypothesis, however a few centres still had a challenge in relating the conclusion with the hypothesis. The conclusion should be for each objective.

Recommendations:

There was a slight improvement in the presentation of recommendations this year, by most centres. Candidates are expected to recommend based on the results of the study and recommendations should be for farmers and for further studies, as stated in the syllabus.

Problems encountered:

Centres are encouraged to ensure that candidates identify problems and suggest solutions to them (limitations).

Sampling:

Proper sampling should be done across the mark range. Centres are encouraged to abide by the numbers stipulated in the syllabus, while sampling i.e.

Total number of candidates	Sample size
0-10	All files
11-50	10
51-100	15
101 & above	20

Each sample needs to consist of the top, middle and bottom students. Sampled candidates should be indicated with an asterisk in the summary sheet.

Packaging:

Paper 4 files should be packaged separately from paper 3 files, with its attendance register, MS1, and summary form, as well as cover letter if need be. Entire material in files should be held with strings, including individual students' cards.

General Comments

There was a slight improvement in the standard of projects this year, owing to the new guide in the syllabus. Very few centres submitted loose projects without files. Very few others submitted files without strings. A few projects were incomplete with one or two chapters. Absent students should be accompanied by a covering letter and candidate's work must be recorded up to the period when he/ she left school. Teachers are discouraged from awarding zeroes to candidates when they have been in the centre participating in learning.

Proper calculations of marks should be done. Whole figures should be written in summary sheets, without decimals.

Punching and stapling of MS1 is unacceptable. Marks should be entered and shaded correctly in the MS1. In the case of an absent candidate, an A should be written and shaded, using HB pencils only and not ink, in the MS1. Both shading and signing of MS1 should be done using a pencil.